PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Syllable Rules #1,2,3

#1. Nouns and adjectives

When a noun (a word referring to a person, place, or thing) or an adjective (a term that describes a noun, e.g., "pretty, happy") has two syllables, the stress or "lingering" is usually on the **first** syllable.

Nouns:

TA ble	**WIN** dow	**PEN** cil
SCI ssors	**PRIN** ter	**PA** per

Adjectives:

PRE tty	**BO** ring	**JEA** lous
CLE ver	**PUR** ple	**CRA** zy

Exceptions: Unfortunately, there are exceptions to this rule.

hotel	"hoe-**TELL**"	concise	"cun-**SISE**"
extreme	"x-**TREEM**"	police	"puh **LEES**"

#2. Verbs and prepositions with two syllables

When a verb (an action or state of being) or a preposition (a relational word, e.g., "behind, around") has two syllables, the stress is usually (around 65% of the time) on the second syllable.

Verbs:

pre **SENT**	pre **TEND**
ex **PORT**	a **PPROACH**

Prepositions:

a **SIDE**	a **ROUND**
be **TWEEN**	su **RROUND**

#3. Words that are both a noun **and** a verb

Some English words can be used as a noun and a verb depending on the context of your sentence. In those cases, if the word is used as a noun, its word stress will be on the first syllable, a verb, the second.

present	**PRE** sent (noun)	vs. present pre **SENT** (verb) give something formally
export	**EX** port (noun)	vs. export ex **PORT** (verb) to sell goods to another country
suspect	**SU** spect (noun)	vs. suspect sus **PECT** (verb) to believe that something is true
permit	**PER** mit (noun)	vs. per **MIT** (verb) to allow
invite	**IN** vite (noun)	vs. in **VITE** (verb) asking a guest to come to a party
object	**OB** ject (noun)	vs. ob **JECT** (verb) lawyer says after a witness has spoken
record	**RE** cord (noun)	vs. re **CORD** (verb) to document something
rebel	**RE** bel (noun)	vs. re **BEL** (verb) to go against the rules
insult	**IN** sult (noun)	vs. in **SULT** (verb) to put someone down
contract	**CON** tract (noun)	vs. con **TRACT** (verb) to get or be infected with
Progress	**PRO** gress (noun)	vs. pro **GRESS** (verb) to improve or move further along
Conflict	**CON** flict (noun)	vs. con **FLICT** (verb) to disagree with or go against